



Ties that bind

Family is an emotional cushion and a sounding board

Celebrating major festivals is a family affair. As many as **42%** say they celebrated them with parents, **35%** enjoyed the day with their spouse/children and **29%** included siblings in the occasion.

The family embrace is all-forgiving, with **43%** discussing personal problems with their parents and relatives rather than with spouse/girlfriend/boyfriend.

Over **50%** consult at least one parent on career options. The opinion of both parents matters to almost **40%** of the youth.

Despite the strong presence of friends in the lives of urban, contemporary young people, **50%** go out with parents, spouse, children and other members of the family.

SUMEET INDER SINGH

Watching television is also a family ritual, with **47%** cosying up with children or other members of the family in front of the TV set



Given a choice, **65%** (61% in nuclear families) would stay with their parents. As many as **60%** still want two children.

the marketplace of multiplicity, remain commodities, done unto rather than doing. So while increasingly men have come to accept—sometimes demand—working wives and the life it buys them, they also expect them to be dutiful daughters-in-law. Cultural conditioning triumphs over contemporary reality, and while the girls grow up to be little women, the men remain little boys, depending on their parents even after they get married, as is evident from the fact that half the married men consult their families on career/financial matters.

So is it that men are from Mars and women from Venus? Or that men don't have a clue and women always need more shoes, in the best traditions of gender gap bestsellers? Women consider family before all else when they look at a prospective husband (eight points above both profession and love), they work fewer hours than their male counterparts (40 per cent men work between nine and 12 hours compared to only 21 per cent of the women), and hey, they even spend less time in school or college. As sociologist Radhika Chopra says, relationships matter above all to women, the traditional nurturers. "It's evident in the little details of everyday life (they enjoy TV a lot but they give that up for men who become the primary viewers late in the night) as well as in the big picture (women look up more to men/parents for career and financial advice). They seek and

What do you think is the right age to get

22-25 yrs

26-30 yrs

18-21 yrs

60

22

18

64% women feel the right age to marry is 22-25. For almost one-third of the men, it is between 26 and 30.